

1. DRAWING INFERENCES

Theory: Drawing an inference means using the information or clues given in a statement or passage to logically arrive at a conclusion that is not directly stated. Avoid unsupported assumptions and choose only what logically follows.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. Statement: The college library remains open until 8 p.m. during examination week.

Inference:

- a) Students can use the library for evening study.
- b) All students study in the library every evening.
- c) The library is closed during the day.
- d) Students are not allowed to study at home.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: The extended evening hours logically allow students to use the library for evening study. The other statements are not given.

2. Statement: The company has introduced work-from-home facilities for employees during heavy rain.

Inference:

- a) Employees will never return to the office.
- b) Employees can work from home during the affected period.
- c) The company has closed permanently.
- d) All employees dislike office work.

Answer: Only b follows

Explanation: The statement directly supports temporary work from home during heavy rain.

3. Statement: Many students submitted their assignments before the deadline.

Inference:

- a) Some students completed their work early.
- b) Every student submitted early.
- c) No student submitted late.

d) The teacher cancelled the deadline.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: The statement supports that many students submitted before the deadline, not that every student did.

4. Statement: The road was blocked because of a fallen tree.

Inference:

- a) Vehicles could not pass normally through that road.
- b) The road was permanently closed.
- c) There was a traffic accident.
- d) The tree was deliberately cut down.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: A blocked road prevents normal passage. The other details are not stated.

5. Statement: The shop is offering a discount on laptops this weekend.

Inference:

- a) Laptops may be available at reduced prices this weekend.
- b) All laptops are free.
- c) The shop is closing permanently.
- d) Customers cannot buy laptops next week.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: A discount means the selling price may be reduced. The other statements are unsupported.

6. Statement: The train was delayed due to heavy fog.

Inference:

- a) The train did not arrive at its scheduled time.
- b) The train was cancelled permanently.
- c) All trains were delayed.
- d) The passengers refused to travel.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: A delay means the train arrived or departed later than scheduled.

7. Statement: The school has installed more computers in the laboratory.

Inference:

- a) Students have more computers available for laboratory work.
- b) Every student owns a computer.
- c) The laboratory will no longer have teachers.
- d) Computer classes have been cancelled.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: Installing more computers increases the available computers in the lab.

8. Statement: The doctor advised the patient to drink more water.

Inference:

- a) The doctor believes adequate water intake is useful for the patient.
- b) The patient must stop eating food.
- c) The patient has no health problem.
- d) Water is the only treatment required.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: The advice supports the usefulness of adequate water intake, but not the other claims.

9. Statement: The museum introduced online ticket booking to reduce queues.

Inference:

- a) Visitors can book tickets online before visiting.
- b) The museum has stopped admitting visitors.
- c) All tickets are free.
- d) Queues will never occur again.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: Online booking provides a way to obtain tickets before arrival.

10. Statement: The students practised daily for the cultural programme.

Inference:

- a) The students were preparing seriously for the programme.
- b) The programme was cancelled.
- c) Only one student participated.
- d) The students disliked the programme.

Answer: Only a follows

Explanation: Daily practice indicates preparation; the other claims are not supported.

2. COHESION WORDS / COHESIVE DEVICES

Theory: Cohesive devices are words and phrases that link ideas, sentences and paragraphs. Examples include however, therefore, moreover, thus, consequently, in addition, similarly, for instance and in conclusion.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. I wanted to go for a walk. _____, it started raining.

- a) Moreover
- b) However
- c) Therefore
- d) Similarly

Answer: b) However

Explanation: However shows contrast.

2. She studied hard; _____, she passed the examination.

- a) therefore
- b) however
- c) although
- d) similarly

Answer: a) therefore

Explanation: Therefore shows a result.

3. The book was informative; _____, it was entertaining.

- a) moreover
- b) however
- c) otherwise
- d) instead

Answer: a) moreover

Explanation: Moreover adds extra information.

4. Many fruits contain vitamins; _____, oranges are rich in vitamin C.

- a) for instance
- b) however
- c) therefore
- d) nevertheless

Answer: a) for instance

Explanation: For instance, introduce an example.

5. The weather was bad; _____, the match was postponed.

- a) similarly
- b) consequently
- c) in addition
- d) for instance

Answer: b) consequently

Explanation: Consequently introduces a result.

6. Ravi likes outdoor games. _____, his brother prefers indoor games.

- a) On the other hand
- b) Therefore
- c) Moreover
- d) Thus

Answer: a) On the other hand

Explanation: It introduces a contrasting preference.

7. The company is expanding; _____, it is hiring more staff.

- a) hence
- b) however
- c) although
- d) instead

Answer: a) hence

Explanation: Hence shows the result of expansion.

8. The meeting was long; _____, it was productive.

- a) nevertheless
- b) therefore
- c) for instance
- d) similarly

Answer: a) nevertheless

Explanation: Nevertheless shows contrast despite the first fact.

9. The team won the match. _____, they celebrated together.

- a) As a result
- b) On the contrary
- c) Although
- d) Similarly

Answer: a) As a result

Explanation: It shows the result of winning.

10. Regular exercise is important. _____, it improves physical fitness.

- a) In addition
- b) However
- c) Instead
- d) On the other hand

Answer: a) In addition

Explanation: In addition another supporting point.

3. DESCRIBING PICTURES

Theory: Picture description means explaining what can be seen in a picture. Mention the main subject, people or objects, actions, place/background and important details. Use clear sentences and simple present tense.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. A picture shows students sitting in a classroom and listening to a teacher. What is the best opening?

- a) This picture shows a classroom scene.
- b) This picture is about a railway station.
- c) I cannot see anything.
- d) The picture is empty.

Answer: a) This picture shows a classroom scene.

Explanation: It introduces the main subject clearly.

2. A picture shows a family eating together at a dining table. Which sentence is suitable?

- a) The family is having a meal together.
- b) The family is travelling by train.
- c) The family is playing football.
- d) The family is inside a laboratory.

Answer: a) The family is having a meal together.

Explanation: It accurately describes the visible action.

3. Which detail should normally be mentioned while describing a picture?

- a) People and their actions
- b) Only the photographer's name
- c) An unrelated story
- d) A random opinion

Answer: a) People and their actions

Explanation: People, objects and actions are important visual details.

4. Which tense is commonly useful for describing what is visible in a picture?

- a) Simple present
- b) Past perfect only
- c) Future perfect only
- d) Past continuous only

Answer: a) Simple present

Explanation: Simple present is useful for describing visible scenes.

5. A picture shows a busy road with cars, buses and pedestrians. Which sentence is suitable?

- a) The road is crowded with vehicles and people.
- b) The road is inside a classroom.
- c) There are no people or vehicles.
- d) Everyone is sleeping.

Answer: a) The road is crowded with vehicles and people.

Explanation: It describes the visible scene.

6. Which is the best order for a picture description?

- a) General view → people/objects → actions → background → overall idea
- b) Conclusion → unrelated story → title
- c) Only background → unrelated details
- d) Opinion → joke → conclusion

Answer: a) General view → people/objects → actions → background → overall idea

Explanation: This gives an organized description.

7. A picture shows students planting trees in a school garden. Which sentence is correct?

- a) The students are planting trees.
- b) The students are flying an airplane.
- c) The students are cooking in a hotel.
- d) The students are swimming.

Answer: a) The students are planting trees.

Explanation: It matches the action shown.

8. Which opening is appropriate for picture description?

- a) In this picture, I can see...
- b) Once upon a time...
- c) Dear Sir...
- d) Yours faithfully...

Answer: a) In this picture, I can see...

Explanation: It directly introduces the visual description.

9. A picture shows a rainy street and people carrying umbrellas. What can be described?

- a) The weather appears rainy.
- b) It is a sunny desert.
- c) There are no people.
- d) The street is inside a building.

Answer: a) The weather appears rainy.

Explanation: The rain and umbrellas support this description.

10. Which should be avoided in a picture description?

- a) Adding unsupported details as facts
- b) Describing visible objects
- c) Describing actions
- d) Mentioning the background

Answer: a) Adding unsupported details as facts

Explanation: A description should stay close to what the picture shows.

4. OPENING PHRASES

Theory: An opening or introductory phrase occurs at the beginning of a sentence and prepares the reader or listener for the main message. It helps create a smooth introduction.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. Identify the opening phrase: 'According to experts, students need enough sleep.'

- a) According to experts
- b) students need
- c) enough sleep
- d) experts

Answer: a) According to experts

Explanation: It appears at the beginning and introduces the statement.

2. Identify the opening phrase: 'In the morning, the students attended the seminar.'

- a) In the morning
- b) the students
- c) attended
- d) the seminar

Answer: a) In the morning

Explanation: It introduces the time of the action.

3. Which is a suitable opening phrase for a presentation?

- a) Today, I would like to talk about...
- b) Yours faithfully
- c) Thank you for the parcel
- d) Dear Manager

Answer: a) Today, I would like to talk about...

Explanation: It clearly introduces a presentation topic.

4. Identify the opening phrase: 'At the end of the day, regular exercise is important.'

- a) At the end of the day
- b) regular exercise
- c) is important
- d) exercise

Answer: a) At the end of the day

Explanation: It occurs at the beginning and introduces the sentence.

5. Which phrase is suitable for starting a discussion?

- a) First of all, let us consider...
- b) Yours sincerely
- c) Dear customer
- d) Invoice number

Answer: a) First of all, let us consider...

Explanation: It naturally begins a discussion.

6. Identify the opening phrase: 'According to recent studies, students who set goals often stay focused.'

- a) According to recent studies
- b) students who set goals
- c) often stay focused
- d) recent studies

Answer: a) According to recent studies

Explanation: It introduces the source of the information.

7. Which is an appropriate opening for a speech?

- a) Good morning everyone.

- b) Yours faithfully.
- c) Dear Sir.
- d) Subject: Leave request

Answer: a) Good morning everyone.

Explanation: It is a standard speech opening.

8. Identify the opening phrase: 'Waking up late, he wished he had set his alarm.'

- a) Waking up late
- b) he wished
- c) set his alarm
- d) his alarm

Answer: a) Waking up late

Explanation: It introduces the situation before the main clause.

9. Which opening phrase introduces an opinion?

- a) In my opinion,
- b) For example,
- c) As a result,
- d) In conclusion,

Answer: a) In my opinion,

Explanation: It signals the speaker's viewpoint.

10. Which opening phrase is suitable for introducing a topic?

- a) Let us begin with...
- b) Yours sincerely
- c) Thank you for your order
- d) Payment due

Answer: a) Let us begin with...

Explanation: It introduces the topic in an organized way.

5. DISFLUENCY WORDS

Theory: Disfluency words are common interruptions in speech, such as filler words like um, uh, like, you know, well and so. Disfluencies can also include repetitions, false starts, silent pauses and revisions.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. Which is a common filler/disfluency word?

- a) um
- b) therefore
- c) moreover
- d) finally

Answer: a) um

Explanation: 'Um' is a common filled pause.

2. Which sentence contains a repetition?

- a) I want to... I want to go home.
- b) I went home early.
- c) I completed the work.
- d) The class started at ten.

Answer: a) I want to... I want to go home.

Explanation: The phrase is repeated.

3. What is a false start?

- a) Starting a sentence, stopping, and restarting it
- b) Speaking very loudly
- c) Reading a paragraph
- d) Using a complete sentence

Answer: a) Starting a sentence, stopping, and restarting it

Explanation: This is the definition of a false start.

4. Which is an example of a filler phrase?

- a) you know
- b) in conclusion
- c) for instance
- d) as a result

Answer: a) you know

Explanation: 'You know' can function as a filler phrase.

5. Which is a silent pause?

- a) A break in speech without a sound
- b) Repeating a word
- c) Adding an example
- d) Speaking continuously

Answer: a) A break in speech without a sound

Explanation: A silent pause contains no filler sound.

6. Which is a revision in speech?

- a) I went to Chennai—sorry, I mean Salem.
- b) I went to Salem.
- c) Good morning everyone.
- d) The class is over.

Answer: a) I went to Chennai—sorry, I mean Salem.

Explanation: The speaker corrects the phrase mid-sentence.

7. Which of these is a prolongation?

- a) Sssssam
- b) Sam
- c) Hello
- d) Goodbye

Answer: a) Sssssam

Explanation: A sound is stretched.

8. Why can too many filler words affect speech?

- a) They can reduce clarity and fluency.
- b) They always improve grammar.
- c) They make every sentence shorter.
- d) They replace all nouns.

Answer: a) They can reduce clarity and fluency.

Explanation: Frequent fillers can interrupt the flow of speech.

9. Which group contains only common disfluency/filler words?

- a) um, uh, like, you know
- b) however, therefore, thus, moreover
- c) first, second, third, fourth
- d) because, although, despite, if

Answer: a) um, uh, like, you know

Explanation: These are common filler expressions.

10. Disfluencies may occur because of:

- a) stress, excitement or tiredness
- b) only happiness
- c) only reading
- d) only writing

Answer: a) stress, excitement or tiredness

Explanation: The source material identifies these as possible causes.

6. WORD STRESS

Theory: Word stress means giving more emphasis to one syllable in a word. A stressed syllable may have a longer vowel, higher pitch, greater loudness and clearer pronunciation.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. What is word stress?

- a) Emphasis given to one syllable of a word
- b) Writing a word in capital letters only
- c) Pausing between sentences
- d) Speaking every syllable equally

Answer: a) Emphasis given to one syllable of a word

Explanation: One syllable receives more emphasis than the others.

2. Which syllable is stressed in 'beautiful'?

- a) BEAU
- b) ti
- c) ful
- d) All equally

Answer: a) BEAU

Explanation: The source gives the stress pattern BEAU-ti-ful.

3. A stressed syllable is usually pronounced:

- a) more clearly and strongly
- b) more silently
- c) without a vowel
- d) only as a whisper

Answer: a) more clearly and strongly

Explanation: Stress involves greater emphasis and clarity.

4. Which is a feature of a stressed syllable?

- a) A longer vowel
- b) No sound
- c) Always a silent pause
- d) Removing the syllable

Answer: a) A longer vowel

Explanation: A stressed syllable can have a longer vowel.

5. Which is another feature of word stress?

- a) Higher pitch
- b) Lower spelling accuracy
- c) No pronunciation
- d) Changing the sentence meaning always

Answer: a) Higher pitch

Explanation: The source lists raising the pitch as a feature.

6. How many syllables are in 'company'?

- a) Three
- b) One
- c) Two
- d) Four

Answer: a) Three

Explanation: It can be divided as com-pa-ny.

7. Which pair shows a stress change that changes meaning/function?

- a) PREsent / preSENT
- b) table / chair
- c) book / pen
- d) cat / dog

Answer: a) PREsent / preSENT

Explanation: Stress placement can distinguish meanings/functions in such word pairs.

8. In 'CONduct' as a noun, where is the main stress?

- a) CON
- b) duct
- c) Both equally
- d) No stress

Answer: a) CON

Explanation: The source gives CONduct for behaviour.

9. In 'preSENT' as a verb, where is the stress?

- a) SENT
- b) PRE
- c) Both equally
- d) No stress

Answer: a) SENT

Explanation: The source gives preSENTed for the verb form.

10. Which set contains features of a stressed syllable?

- a) Longer vowel, higher pitch, louder, clearer
- b) Silent, shorter, softer, unclear
- c) Only spelling changes
- d) Only punctuation changes

Answer: a) Longer vowel, higher pitch, louder, clearer

Explanation: These are key features described in the source.

7. THREE PARTS OF A PARAGRAPH

Theory: A paragraph has three main parts: topic sentence, supporting sentences and concluding sentence. The topic sentence introduces the main idea; supporting sentences develop it with details, reasons or examples; the concluding sentence closes the idea.

EXERCISE – CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. What are the three parts of a paragraph?

- a) Topic sentence, supporting sentences, concluding sentence
- b) Title, address, signature
- c) Greeting, body, signature
- d) Question, answer, example

Answer: a) Topic sentence, supporting sentences, concluding sentence

Explanation: These are the three main parts.

2. What is the function of a topic sentence?

- a) It introduces the main idea.
- b) It gives the final conclusion only.
- c) It signs the paragraph.
- d) It gives the page number.

Answer: a) It introduces the main idea.

Explanation: The topic sentence tells what the paragraph is about.

3. What do supporting sentences do?

- a) Explain and develop the main idea
- b) Only end the paragraph
- c) Give the writer's name
- d) Start a letter

Answer: a) Explain and develop the main idea

Explanation: They provide details, examples, reasons or facts.

4. What is the function of a concluding sentence?

- a) To close the paragraph and complete the idea
- b) To introduce a completely new topic
- c) To give an address
- d) To ask for permission

Answer: a) To close the paragraph and complete the idea

Explanation: It provides a suitable ending.

5. Identify the topic sentence: 'Exercise is important for a healthy life. It keeps the body active. It also reduces stress. Therefore, everyone should exercise regularly.'

- a) Exercise is important for a healthy life.
- b) It keeps the body active.
- c) It also reduces stress.
- d) Therefore, everyone should exercise regularly.

Answer: a) Exercise is important for a healthy life.

Explanation: It introduces the paragraph's main idea.

6. Which sentence is a supporting sentence in the same paragraph?

- a) It keeps the body active.
- b) Exercise is important for a healthy life.
- c) Therefore, everyone should exercise regularly.
- d) Exercise.

Answer: a) It keeps the body active.

Explanation: It supports the main idea with a detail.

7. Which sentence is the concluding sentence in the exercise paragraph?

- a) Therefore, everyone should exercise regularly.

- b) Exercise is important for a healthy life.
- c) It keeps the body active.
- d) It also reduces stress.

Answer: a) Therefore, everyone should exercise regularly.

Explanation: It brings the paragraph to a close.

8. Which part usually contains examples, reasons or facts?

- a) Supporting sentences
- b) Topic sentence only
- c) Concluding sentence only
- d) Title

Answer: a) Supporting sentences

Explanation: Supporting sentences develop the main idea.

9. Which is the best order of paragraph parts?

- a) Topic → Supporting → Concluding
- b) Concluding → Topic → Supporting
- c) Supporting → Concluding → Topic
- d) Topic → Concluding → Supporting

Answer: a) Topic → Supporting → Concluding

Explanation: This is the standard organization.

10. A good paragraph should mainly have:

- a) One clear main idea developed with supporting details
- b) Many unrelated ideas
- c) Only one word
- d) Only a conclusion

Answer: a) One clear main idea developed with supporting details

Explanation: Supporting details should develop the central idea.
